

# Course milestone M9: Bounded Research Note and Claim-Evidence Table

## HONR 46400 · Evidence-Driven Research

### What to submit

One file, `lastname_m09.pdf`. Everything this milestone asks for goes inside it, as sections in the order below.

Submit it on Brightspace, under **Assignments** then **M09**. Brightspace carries the deadline.

This milestone presents **Book Milestone 9: Your bounded claims** (checkpoint, version 1) of the course book, EDR|AI.

### What this course adds

#### Finish this one at the Friday studio

You develop the note across the week and finish it at the Friday studio. Bring a complete draft of the note and the claim-to-evidence table with you. A partial draft cannot be red-teamed, so arrive with real sentences, not an outline.

1. **Trade notes with a peer.** Your peer reads your note the way a stranger would, with no explanation from you. You read theirs the same way. Note every place a reader stumbled or asked “how do you know that?”.
2. **Revise, then submit the same day.** Fold in what the red-team found, then submit before the studio closes.

#### Two course specifics for the note

- **Your numbers are not new this week.** Every figure in the note walks back to a cell in the seeded analysis notebook you submitted for M7 (`SEED = 464`) and to the checks you adjudicated in your M8 audit. You are writing the sentences your existing evidence licenses.
- **Keep the note to one or two pages**, written for a reader who has only that page in front of them.

#### How this part is judged

A note that ignores what the red-team found loses craft points. A headline number that does not rerun from the notebook it traces to drops verification to the lowest band.

### Milestone 9: Your bounded claims

#### Open the milestone workbook in Colab

**This chapter closes Studio 9: Write, bound, and disclose.** Its lessons each ended at **It is your turn**; what you wrote there arrives here as working material, and this is where the pieces become one artifact you can defend.

**What this milestone produces.** A stand-alone research note or report draft, a claim-to-evidence table, and your AI disclosure statement.

#### What you bring

You also carry forward the last milestone’s artifact: **Milestone 8: Your robustness audit**. This one builds on it, and the chain assumes it is versioned and filed.

Check you are carrying each of these before you start. If one is missing, go back and work that lesson’s **It is your turn** first; the practice below assumes it.

- Lesson 28: From Results to Claims: your claims with verbs downgraded to what the design established, each carrying its boundary line.
- Lesson 29: Claim–Evidence Tables: your claim-evidence table, one row per claim with claim, evidence, trace, and boundary, every number traced to its output.

- Lesson 30: AI Disclosure and Research Integrity: your AI-use disclosure, written from the ledger and naming what you did not verify.
- Lesson 31: From Dossier to Research Note: your stand-alone note draft: the problem-gap-question spine, methods, results with uncertainty, discussion, ordered findings with the headline claim's boundary inside, references, your disclosure placed, and the pointer to the package Studio 11 will freeze.

## The practice

1. Write your claim as one sentence, with its boundary attached in the same sentence.
2. Build the claim-to-evidence table: every claim, the output that supports it, and the check that verified it.
3. State your uncertainty and your limitations in the words a reader outside your field would use.
4. Write your AI disclosure from your ledger, not from memory.

## A version, not a pass

Your milestone artifact is a dated, numbered **version** with the reason for the version attached. When later evidence changes it, you write the next version rather than editing the last one, because the sequence of changes is itself part of your research record.

## The four rails, here

Four concerns cross every studio in this book. At this milestone they take these specific forms.

- **Ethics, permissions, and data exposure.** Disclosure includes what you sent to tools, not only what they produced.
- **Evidence, provenance, and reproducibility.** A claim with no row in the table does not appear in the draft.
- **AI activity, verification, and human decisions.** The sentence that ships is yours, whatever drafted it.
- **Uncertainty, claim boundary, and revision history.** Findings are never communicated as certainties.

## Where this milestone sits

You arrived carrying Milestone 8: Your robustness audit. Milestone 10 adapts these bounded claims to a real audience and rehearses their defense. The chain ends at Milestone 12: Your release and next cycle, where you decide whether your finished research artifact leaves your hands.

## What sends you back

A claim you cannot fit in the table is a claim to cut or a check to run, and both send you back a studio.

## How this milestone is assessed

Each row scores **0, 1, or 2. 10 points total.**

| # | Criterion                                                                 | 0                                                                   | 1                                                                              | 2                                                                       |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The milestone artifact exists in full, specific to your own project       | absent, or generic text that would fit any project                  | present but incomplete, or specific in some parts and generic in others        | complete and unmistakably about your project                            |
| 2 | The milestone is written as a dated, numbered version with its reason     | no version, or a version with no reason given                       | versioned, but the reason is decorative rather than an account of what changed | versioned with a reason a reader could use to reconstruct your thinking |
| 3 | Every judgment in the artifact is defended by you, not asserted by a tool | conclusions appear with no reasoning, or reproduce a tool's wording | reasoning present but thin where the decision was hardest                      | each judgment carries a reason you could defend under questioning       |
| 4 | The four rails are carried in the form this studio requires               | one or more rails absent where this studio required them            | all rails present but one is nominal                                           | every rail addressed in the form this studio requires                   |

| # | Criterion                                                                                                                                                       | 0                                      | 1                                                | 2                                |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 5 | The milestone's own product is present and defensible: A stand-alone research note or report draft, a claim-to-evidence table, and your AI disclosure statement | the milestone's own product is missing | present but would not survive a careful question | present and defensible as stated |

### ! Blocking gate

No work at or after Studio 4 proceeds past a not-authorized determination. This is not scored and cannot be averaged away.

## Your workbook

Open the workbook with the link above. It walks these steps with a cell for each one, ends by writing your milestone version with its reason, and adds the rows this studio contributes to your AI Research Ledger and your Research Dossier.